



◀ FG42 AUTOMATIC RIFLE

Date	1943
Origin	Germany
Barrel	19¾in (50.2cm)
Caliber	7.92 × 57mm Mauser

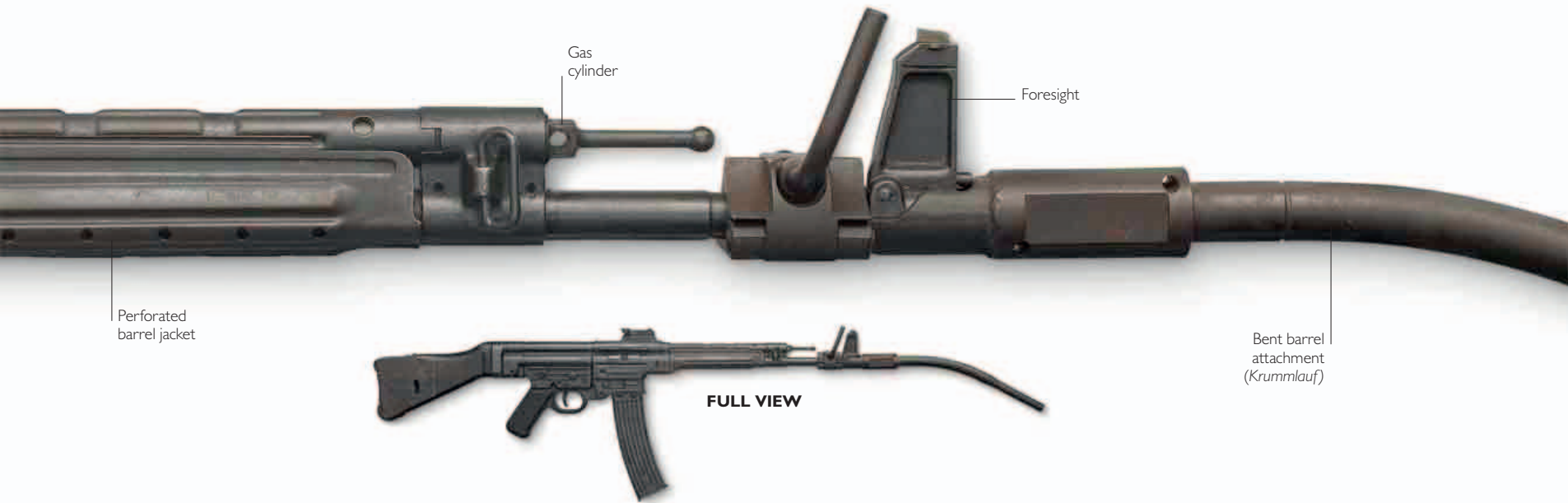
The FG42 was a fully automatic weapon designed to provide long-range firepower to paratroopers on the ground. It pioneered a “straight-line” butt-to-muzzle layout. Its gas-operated rotating bolt mechanism, also seen in the semiautomatic M1 Carbine (see p.177), was unusual among automatic arms. The bolt was unlocked by the carrier, which had a slot that caused the bolt to turn as it was driven rearward.



▲ M1A1 CARBINE WITH FOLDING STOCK

Date	1942
Origin	US
Barrel	18in (45.7cm)
Caliber	.30in

The M1 Carbine (see p.177) had already proved popular with soldiers who needed a lightweight weapon. For airborne forces, this special M1A1 variant was produced, complete with a folding stock for use during parachute drops.



FULL VIEW